EPISODE 01

1 EXT. SCHOOL GATE - DAY 1

A sleek, bright red convertible SPEEDS into view, drawing the attention of bystanders. The car SCREECHES to a stop.

GRAY, dressed in stylish casual wear, LEAPS out of the driver's seat without opening the door. He swings around to the back, pulling out a bouquet of lilies. His face beams with excitement as he rushes to the passenger side and GENTLY OPENS the door.

ALICE steps out gracefully, dressed in an elegant old-money ensemble. She casually removes her sunglasses, her expression poised and confident.

Gray hands her the bouquet and pulls her into a tight hug.

GRAY
(excited)
Sis, don't forget! You have to meet my girlfriend, Ashley at the alumni charity gala.

Alice tilts her head, teasing him.

ALICE
(amused)
I know! You mentioned it so many times on the way here, it's obvious you're into her.

GRAY
(grinning, thrilled)
Of course! She's the most perfect, kind-hearted woman I've ever met!

ALICE
(smiling playfully)
Then I'm really looking forward to meeting her. Alright, see you later!

CLOSE-UP: Gray and Alice exchange a cheek kiss before parting.

Hiding behind a flowerbed nearby, NICOLE watches in shock, covering her mouth.

NICOLE
(whispering, to herself)
Holy carp! Wait……That's Gray, Asley's boy friend!

Nicole quickly pulls out her phone, adjusts the angle carefully, and RAPIDLY SNAPS multiple photos. She immediately sends them to an Instagram group chat.

NICOLE (cont'd)
(typing)
Ashley, there's a woman getting really cozy with Gray at the school gate! Could he be cheating on you?!

2 INT. ALUMNI ROOM - VIP LOUNGE - DAY 2

The VIP lounge is under renovation, with workers finishing up an oil painting restoration. Ashley, surrounded by Nicole and her FOLLOWER 1 and 2, flaunts her Swan family crest badge.

ASHLEY
(bragging)
I heard Gray is planning to propose to me. After tonight, I'll officially be the fiancée of the Swan family's second heir!

Her minions gaze at her with admiration, their eyes fixed on the emblem.

FOLLOWER 1
(grinning)
Gray is rich and handsome. Ashley, congrats on securing a lifetime meal ticket!

ASHLEY
(smugly)
I also heard Gray has a very powerful sister. I need to find a way to win her over. That way, once I marry Gray, I'll get Swan Group shares too.

FOLLOWER 2
(encouraging)
You've got this!

Ashley basks in their admiration—until her phone VIBRATES. She glances at the screen, reading Nicole's message. Her expression IMMEDIATELY DARKENS.

ASHLEY
(outraged)
Who the hell is this woman?!

CLOSE-UP: Ashley enlarges the photo—Gray and Alice cheek-to-cheek.

Follower 1 peeks over her shoulder.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(seething)
That BITCH actually dares to flirt with Gray on MY turf?!

FOLLOWER 1
(smirking)
Everyone knows Gray is yours. This is a direct challenge.

FOLLOWER 2
(egging her on)
If she steals him, you'll lose your ticket to the Swan fortune. You'd better put her in her place!

Alice enters at that moment.

Ashley spots her and IMMEDIATELY STORMS FORWARD, her fake smile vanishing.

Ashley's eyes land on a nearby bucket of red paint, left by the workers. She PICKS IT UP.

In one swift motion, she SLAPS Alice across the face before DUMPING the red paint over her.

CLOSE-UP: The bouquet of lilies Gray gifted Alice—now drenched in red paint.

Alice stares at Ashley in disbelief, as if looking at a lunatic.

EPISODE 02

3 INT. ALUMNI ROOM - VIP LOUNGE - DAY 3

Ashley glares at Alice, her fury exploding.

ASHLEY
(venomous)
You slut! How dare you seduce my boyfriend?!

Alice, her face still smeared with paint, retaliates with a HARD SLAP.

ALICE
(coldly)
What the hell are you talking about?

Ashley clutches her face, her cheek now imprinted with a vivid paint-covered hand print. She looks FURIOUS.

ASHLEY
(enraged)
You hit me?! You actually hit me!

Ashley signals NICOLE, who immediately pulls out her phone, enlarging the picture.

CLOSE-UP: Gray giving Alice flowers, their body language intimate.

NICOLE
(accusingly)
OMG, you're totally a home-wrecking whore!

ALICE
(scoffing)
If I’m the homewrecker, what does that make you?

Nicole JABS a finger at Ashley’s chest, where the Swan family crest badge.

NICOLE
(proudly)
Look at this crest. Look! Ashley is Gray’s official girlfriend! The future fiancée of Swan Group’s heir! And I’m her best friend.

Nicole steps closer, her voice dripping with malice.

NICOLE (cont'd)
(taunting)
I suggest you get on your knees and apologize to Ashley. Or else…

Alice’s eyes shift to the emblem.

ALICE
(casual)
So… you’re Gray’s girlfriend?

She lowers her head, seemingly in thought.

ALICE (V.O.)
She doesn't seem as kind as Gray described. Looks like I'll need to keep a low-profile and observe.

Alice looks up, locking eyes with Ashley.

ALICE
(evenly)
Even if you are Gray's girlfriend, that doesn't give you the right to attack other people. Do you know who I am?

ASHLEY
(scoffs, arrogant)
It doesn't matter who you are. This is my territory, and I make the rules here!

Alice raises an eyebrow.

ALICE
(amused)
Are you sure you want to talk to me like that?

Ashley starts SHOVING Alice, her voice dripping with contempt.

ASHLEY
(mocking)
You actually think you can threaten me?! Let me make this clear—Gray is MINE! Stay away from him!

Alice crosses her arms.

ALICE
(smirks)
Oh? You're lecturing me now? You do realize that without me, he'd be nothing.

4 FOLLOWER 1 LAUGHS LOUDLY. 4

FOLLOWER 1
(snickering)
Oh my god, are you saying Gray owes everything to YOU? Who the hell do you think you are?!

Alice pulls out her phone, dialing Gray's number.

ALICE
(firmly)
I'm calling Gray. And you'll find out exactly who I am.

EPISODE 03

5 INT. ALUMNI ROOM - VIP LOUNGE - DAY 5

Alice stands, phone in hand. The atmosphere in the room shifts—everyone is struck by her commanding presence. Ashley grows visibly tense.

FOLLOWER 1
(whispering)
Is she really someone important?

FOLLOWER 2
(suspicious)
Could she be from the Swan family?

ASHLEY
(snapping, trying to dismiss them)
Don't scare yourselves. There's no such person in the Swan family! Gray only has one sister. She's the genius investor who made Swan Group New York's top rising empire.

NICOLE
(realization dawning)
Wait… No way! Could she actually be Gray's sister?

ASHLEY
(panicking, forcing composure)
Impossible! Gray told me himself that his sister is overseas at an investor summit!

Everyone watches Alice. Gray's phone remains unanswered. Alice lowers her phone. Ashley exhales in relief, her arrogance returning.

FOLLOWER 1
(mocking)
Well, well, look who just embarrassed herself!
(MORE)

FOLLOWER 1 (CONT'D)
Gray didn’t pick up? Hah! Now, tell us... who exactly are you?

NICOLE
(condescending)
Just because you slept with Gray doesn’t make you important.

Ashley steps closer, running her fingers across Alice’s face before giving her a humiliating pat.

ASHLEY
(gritting her teeth)
You really have the face of a cheap little tramp.

Alice SLAPS Ashley across the face, knocking her hand away.

ALICE
(coldly)
Now you’ve really pissed me off, Ashley.

ASHLEY
(stunned, then furious, raising her hand to strike back)
So what?! What can you do to me?

Alice GRABS Ashley’s wrist, squeezing tightly before shoving it away.

ALICE
(low, firm)
You will never enter the Swan family because I will never let you marry Gray.

ASHLEY
(scoffs)
And what power do you have to stop me?

Alice methodically dusts off her fingers, completely unbothered.

ALICE
(smug)
I am all the power that it takes.

ASHLEY
(fuming)
Oh really? How so?

ALICE
(tilts her chin, composed)
I'm Gray's sister. The rightful heir to Swan Group. And I do not approve of this marriage.

Ashley and her followers freeze. Then, Ashley suddenly BURSTS into LAUGHTER. Nicole follows. The others CHUCKLE.

ASHLEY
(mocking, looking Alice up and down)
You? Gray's sister?

NICOLE
(laughing)
Even I know Gray's sister is not in the country. You really think you can impersonate her?

Ashley waves her hand—her minions GRAB Alice's arms. Ashley YANKS a fistful of Alice's hair.

ALICE
(eyes burning, deliberate)
You'll find out soon enough.

Alice struggles. Ashley smirks and gestures to her lackeys.

NICOLE
(snide)
You think you can scare us? You'll totally pay for this.

The girls move in to strip Alice's clothes. Ashley watches with a twisted grin, as the SHRILL LAUGHTER of her lackeys ECHOES in Alice's ears. Alice desperately shields herself.

EPISODE 04

6 INT. ALUMNI ROOM - VIP LOUNGE - DAY 6

Alice struggles violently.

ALICE
(struggling, furious)
Let me go! If you want proof I'm Gray's sister, just call him and ask!

Ashley raises her heel and SLAMS it down onto Alice's hand.

ALICE SCREAMS in pain.

ASHLEY
(smirking)
No need. I know what he'll say, so you'd better disappear forever.

ALICE
(wincing, seething)
Ashley, you will regret this.

NICOLE
(mocking)
Look at her...still making threats.

FOLLOWER 1
(smirks)
Still acting like she’s someone important. You really think we’re stupid enough to believe you’re Gray’s sister?

ALICE
(defiant)
I am.

ASHLEY
You still don’t get it... Since she’s dreaming, let’s wake you up the hard way.

Ashley crouches down and YANKS off Alice’s coat.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(grinning maliciously)
I’ll ruin your face, record your humiliation, and show Gray what a pathetic mess you really are. You’ll regret ever touching my man.

Alice is left in just a camisole, her arms crossed tightly over her chest.

Ashley pulls out her phone and hits RECORD.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(laughing)
Come on, let’s give everyone a show. Let’s see what you’ve got to offer.

Alice thrashes, but the minions HOLD HER DOWN, too strong to fight off.

ALICE
(low, deadly)
You'll regret this.

ASHLEY
(chuckles, amused)
Regret? You should be begging me right now.

The girls FORCE Alice onto the ground, her cheek pressed against Ashley's shoe.

Ashley grabs a nearby PEN. She twirls it once before suddenly STABBING it down—aiming for Alice's face.

The PEN STABS into the WOOD FLOOR—barely an inch from Alice's cheek.

CLOSE-UP: Alice's desperate, helpless expression.

Suddenly, Gray's assistant, JASON, BURSTS into the room. His eyes widen at the horrific scene before him.

JASON
(shouting, horrified)
WHAT THE HELL ARE YOU DOING?! STOP RIGHT NOW!

EPISODE 05

7 INT. ALUMNI ROOM - VIP LOUNGE - DAY 7

The minions GASP, startled, and quickly release Alice.

Jason steps forward, his face darkening in shock as he sees Alice on the floor.

JASON
(stunned, furious)
You… you actually did this to her?

Ashley's eyes immediately LOCK onto Jason. In an instant, her demeanor shifts from domineering to pitiful.

ASHLEY
(snarling at her followers)
How could you?! Who gave you permission to bully her like this?!

Ashley crouches down, pretending to help Alice up.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(softly, full of fake concern)
Are you hurt? This all must be a misunderstanding.

Alice winces, her brows furrowing. She SLAPS Ashley's hand away.

ALICE (V.O.)
Unbelievable. She's so shameless! What a good actor. If I don't expose her in front of Gray, she'll just keep lying her way out of everything.

Jason quickly approaches, instinctively about to call "Alice", but Alice subtly SHAKES HER HEAD, stopping him.

JASON
(slight hesitation, then politely)
...Miss, what happened here?

Ashley turns to Jason, her voice trembling, eyes filled with fake distress.

ASHLEY
(almost sobbing)
It's my fault… My friend Nicole thought this lady was being mean to me and lost her temper. I tried to stop her, but—

Ashley lowers her head, fingers lightly brushing her cheek as if reliving a terrible memory.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(sighing dramatically)
I tried my best to stop it, but she still got hurt… God, I feel so guilty. I don't think I'll be able to sleep tonight.

Alice's eyes widen. She lets out a SHARP LAUGH, utterly incredulous.

ALICE
(scoffing)
Wow. You're actually rewriting reality? Go on, then. Tell me—how exactly did I bully you?

Ashley's fake sorrow vanishes instantly. Her face darkens as she suddenly steps forward, blocking Jason's view.

She reaches out as if to fix Alice's hair—but instead, she GRIPS a handful and YANKS it hard.

ASHLEY
(low, cold, venomous)
Jason is here. If you dare say a word, you're dead.

Alice doesn't hesitate. She lifts her hand—

ALICE
(casually, with a smirk)
You said I bullied you? Was it like this?

SLAP! Ashley's head SNAPS to the side, eyes wide in shock.

Ashley clutches her stinging cheek, her expression twisting in rage.

ASHLEY
(snarling)
You bitch—

Alice tilts her head innocently.

ALICE
(sweetly)
Oh, I see. That wasn't enough? Then how about this.

She RAISES HER OTHER HAND—SLAP!

Ashley's face whips in the opposite direction. The entire room falls SILENT. Alice smiles, tilting her head as if considering something.

ALICE (cont'd)
(smirking)
Or was it more like that?

Ashley SHRIEKS in rage, lunging for Alice — Alice SHOVES HER HARD.

Ashley stumbles back, losing her balance. She FALLS onto the floor, humiliated. Alice steps forward, planting her foot firmly on Ashley's hand, keeping her pinned.

ASHLEY
(screaming, struggling)
You—!

Alice kneels slightly, grabbing Ashley’s chin, forcing her to look up.

ALICE
(voice icy, eyes narrowing)
You're dreaming if you think you'll get my forgiveness.

Her gaze flickers to a nearby paint bucket. Alice smirks. She REACHES OUT, tipping the bucket over—

A WAVE OF THICK, RED PAINT CRASHES DOWN onto Ashley.

Ashley’s expression morphs into horror as the paint DRENCHES her from head to toe. Her SCREAM echoes through the room. Alice watches coolly.

ALICE (cont'd)
(mocking, wiping her hands)
Don’t look at me like that. I’m just giving you exactly what you asked for.

Ashley trembles with rage, drenched in paint, her face a picture of humiliation.

EPISODE 06

8 INT. ALUMNI ROOM - VIP LOUNGE - DAY 8

Ashley, covered in red paint, looks utterly disheveled. She presses her hands against the floor, struggling to get up, her fists clenching so tightly that her knuckles turn white.

Nicole rushes to Ashley’s side, helping her up. She then glares at Alice, rolling up her sleeves, ready to charge.

NICOLE
(screeching)
This bitch is too arrogant! I’m going to teach her a lesson!

Ashley grabs Nicole’s arm, stopping her.

ASHLEY
(gritting her teeth, voice low)
Jason is here. Stay calm. Don’t mess things up.

Alice stands with her arms crossed, looking down at Ashley, amused.

ALICE (V.O.)
This woman will endure anything just to marry into a wealthy family. If she can tolerate this, she must be truly shameless. I'll give her a little warning for now, but I must expose her true face to Gray.

Alice smirks, her eyes filled with mockery.

ALICE
(smirking)
I'll let you go this time, for Gray's sake. But you'd better watch your mouth and stop creating trouble.

Alice glances at Jason, who quickly understands his cue. He composes himself, then steps forward with a polite smile.

JASON
(gently, smiling)
Ladies, since this was just a misunderstanding, let's talk things out peacefully. There's no need to escalate the situation. (beat) Wait a second.

Jason turns around, walks to the table and grabs the an exquisite box. He comes back toward Ashley, holding it with both hands. He bows slightly as he presents it to her.

JASON (cont'd)
(respectfully)
Miss Ashley, Young Master Gray asked me to deliver this to you. He said you would need it later.

Ashley immediately straightens up and accepts the box. She quickly opens it and sees an antique blue and white porcelain vase. A flicker of satisfaction crosses her eyes.

ASHLEY
(sweetly, her voice dripping with affection)
Thank you. Gray is always so thoughtful.

Alice furrows her brows slightly, a hint of disapproval flashing across her face. She shakes her head in silent frustration.

ALICE (V.O.)
Gray, you idiot. How could you give her something so valuable? You're completely love blind.

JASON
Ladies, have a nice day!

Ashley watches Jason leave, her expression quickly turning cold. She suddenly raises her hand, aiming to slap Alice.

Alice reacts instantly, grabbing Ashley's wrist firmly before the slap can land.

ALICE
(calmly, with a hint of warning)
As soon as Jason leaves you reveal your true colors. You might want to think twice—he's still nearby.

Ashley grits her teeth, her face flushed with anger. She yanks her hand away, her breath heavy with suppressed rage.

ASHLEY
(low, furious)
You'll pay for this.

Alice meets her glare head-on, unfazed.

ALICE
(smirking slightly)
I'll be waiting.

Ashley, momentarily unsettled by Alice's piercing gaze, quickly regains her composure. Crossing her arms, she turns on her heel and strides away with her followers. As she passes Alice, she deliberately shoulder-checks her, making sure to leave a final act of defiance.

EPISODE 07

9 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 9

The grand banquet hall is lavishly decorated. Well-dressed GUESTS mingle, LAUGHTER and CHATTER filling the space. Champagne glasses clink elegantly.

CLOSE-UP: A large banner reading “Charity Donation Gala” hangs on the wall.

Ashley, holding an exquisitely wrapped gift box, stands surrounded by Nicole and her followers. A smug smile lingers on her lips.

Nicole leans in toward Ashley, her face filled with admiration.

NICOLE
(awed)
Holy crap! Gray spent a fortune donating under your name. You’re definitely going to be the center of attention tonight.

ASHLEY
(arrogantly, playing with the ribbon on the box)
You don’t understand. Gray told me his sister is passionate about charity. I’m just playing my cards right—makes it easier for me to marry into the family.

The grand doors open slowly. Alice strides in, dressed in an elegant gown, exuding confidence. All eyes turn to her.

The followers nudge Ashley as they notice Alice entering the room.

FOLLOWER 2
(pointing)
Look! That gold-digger showed up too.

Ashley turns, sneering at Alice. Laughter erupts among her group. They quickly stride over and surround Alice.

ASHLEY
(rolling her eyes)
Showing up empty-handed at a charity gala? What, hoping to be some Cinderella who lands a rich husband? Have you looked in a mirror? Stop embarrassing yourself.

NICOLE
(mocking)
Some women love using events like this to cozy up to powerful men. Nothing new.

Alice stands her ground, unfazed, her smile sharp.

ALICE
(firmly, countering)
Everything I have, I earned—unlike some people who treat gold-digging as a skill and brag about it.

Ashley's face darkens at the remark, her tone turning sharp.

ASHLEY
(scoffing)
Oh please. Who knows if anything you have is even real? Didn't someone fake their identity before?

The PRESIDENT of the alumni association steps onto the stage, microphone in hand.

PRESIDENT (V.O.)
Ladies and gentlemen, the charity donation event is now officially underway! First, let's welcome Miss Ashley to the stage to present her donation.

As Ashley passes by Alice, she deliberately lowers her voice and said:

ASHLEY
Watch closely. I'm the one who belongs by Gray's side. Consider yourself lucky just to witness it.

Ashley smirks, casting a condescending glance at Alice before confidently stepping onto the stage with the gift box. She hands the box to the PRESIDENT of the alumni association, who unveils it.

PRESIDENT
(politely, smiling)
Oh my! A piece of blue and white porcelain from the East— an exquisite cultural relic! Thank you, Miss Ashley, for your generous donation.

Ashley struts off the stage, her gaze locked onto Alice, exuding arrogance.

PRESIDENT (V.O.)
Now, let's welcome Miss Alice to the stage.

Murmurs ripple through the crowd. Alice steps forward calmly, her expression unwavering.

FOLLOWER 1
Slut! You didn't bring anything—what are you donating?

ALICE
(smiling faintly)
Who said I didn't bring anything?

Alice reaches up to the stage and slowly removes a necklace from around her neck. Under the lights, the necklace sparkles brilliantly.

The PRESIDENT, suddenly freezes. His eyes widen in shock. In the blink of an eye, he rushes toward Alice with visible excitement.

PRESIDENT
(voice trembling, in disbelief)
This… this is…!!! You—you're…

EPISODE 08

10 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 10

The room buzzes with WHISPERS.

GUEST 1
(confused)
What did she bring? Why is the president so excited?

The PRESIDENT stands on stage, his gaze full of admiration as he carefully takes Alice's donation in both hands.

A server walks onto the stage carrying a necklace holder. The PRESIDENT carefully places the necklace on it, allowing it to rest gracefully.

CLOSE-UP: The president lifts the holder, raising it high for everyone to see.

PRESIDENT
(voice booming with excitement)
This is the Eye of Cyrus, a priceless royal treasure! It was said to have been in the Swan family's collection for 25 years!

He walks toward Alice, his hands slightly raised in a gesture of deep appreciation.

PRESIDENT (cont'd)
(grateful)
This… this is a legendary artifact! I never imagined I'd see it in my lifetime. Miss Alice, your donation is truly extraordinary.

Before he can finish, Ashley suddenly storms onto the stage, snatching the microphone from the president.

ASHLEY
(scoffing)
This is what your alumni association calls "prestigious"? Getting scammed by a gold-digger with a FAKE treasure?

She turns to the PRESIDENT, her lips curling in contempt.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(smirking)
If you can't even tell real from fake, maybe it's time for you to retire.

Alice stands tall, her gaze locked onto Ashley, a cold smirk forming at the corners of her lips.

ALICE
(mocking)
Look at you-a "fake heiress" who needs your fiancé to donate in your name! You have no right to judge priceless treasures!

Ashley's face FLUSHES RED. Her hands tremble with rage. Desperate, she YANKS the necklace from around her neck and holds it up high.

ASHLEY
(yelling)
I DO have the right—because the REAL Eye of Cyrus is right here! And YOU'RE the fraud!

Ashley shoots Alice a scornful look, rolling her eyes.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(sneering)
People like you should be grateful just to have a cheap knockoff.

Gasps ripple through the crowd. A wave of murmurs spreads across the hall. Alice's eyes widen slightly. Her lips part in shock.

ALICE
(stunned, whispering to herself)
How… how could she have that?

EPISODE 09

11 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 11

Ashley smirks, lifting her necklace high.

ASHLEY
(triumphant)
Because my fiancé is Gray—the heir of the Swan family!

She proudly displays the Eye of Cyrus in her hands.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(loudly)
Take a good look, everyone! The real Eye of Cyrus is in MY hands!

She hands the necklace to the PRESIDENT. He takes it, his brows furrowing as he inspects it carefully. His eyes widen in visible shock.

PRESIDENT
(skeptical, voice raised)
The Eye of Cyrus is a one-of-a-kind artifact… How can there be two identical pieces?

The president put the necklace on another necklace holder which is carried by the server. Ashley folds her arms, chin lifted high, throwing a condescending glance at Alice.

ASHLEY
(smirking, acidic tone)
Obviously, someone is using a fake. Isn't that right, Alice?

ALICE
(chuckles coldly)
Indeed.

Ashley turns to the PRESIDENT.

ASHLEY
(insistent)
Go ahead, examine them. Tell everyone who the real fraud is.

The president hesitates, his face full of concern. Ashley leans in, pressing him further.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(pressuring)
Look closely. I'm about to be engaged to Gray—I'm the fiancée of the Swan Group's heir.

The PRESIDENT exhales, spreading his hands apologetically.

PRESIDENT
(apologetic)
I'm sorry… but I can't verify their authenticity on the spot.

Ashley scoffs, placing her hands on her hips.

ASHLEY
(mocking Alice)
Oh, I see. You brought this so-called legendary treasure here because you knew no one could authenticate it!

Ashley suddenly SNATCHES Alice's necklace from the holder.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(snarling)
Let's end this right now! Fake jewelry doesn't belong here!

CLOSE-UP: Alice's eyes widen. The PRESIDENT looks horrified. Guests GASP, breath catching.

PRESIDENT
(panicked)
Wait! That's the Eye of Cyrus!

ASHLEY
(scoffing)
Just a worthless fake.

She lifts the necklace, preparing to SHATTER it.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(confidently)
I'm the fiancée of the Swan heir!
(MORE)

ASHLEY (CONT'D)
If I say it’s fake, who dares question me?!

Alice’s sharp gaze narrows, her expression darkening.

ALICE (V.O.)
Why does she keep saying Gray is the heir? She doesn't understand that I’m the successor of the Swan family.

GASP! Ashley swings to destroy the necklace. The PRESIDENT lunges forward, grabbing it tightly, stepping back in alarm.

PRESIDENT
(frantic)
No, no, no! You can’t break it! What if you destroy the real one?! Swan Group's VP, Mr. Joe, is on his way. Once he arrives, he'll be able to tell which one is real.

Ashley stiffens at his words. Her confident smirk FALTERS.

ASHLEY (V.O.)
What? Joe is coming?

Alice smiles, amused.

ALICE
(softly, mocking)
Oh? Mr. Joe is coming? He’s seen the real Eye of Cyrus.

CLOSE-UP: Ashley’s fist clenches tightly.

ALICE (cont'd)
(teasing)
What’s wrong? Getting nervous?

Ashley takes a deep breath, forcing a smile.

ASHLEY
(faking calmness)
Me? Nervous? I am Gray’s fiancée—the rightful owner of the Eye of Cyrus. Why would I be nervous?

Alice raises a brow, smirking.

ALICE
(smirking)
Great. Then let’s wait for Joe and hear what he says.

CLOSE-UP: Alice scans the crowd with a firm, unwavering gaze.

ALICE (cont'd)
(firmly)
Once Joe arrives, you’ll all know exactly who I am.

EPISODE 10

12 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 12

The banquet hall doors slowly swing open. JOE strides in, his presence immediately drawing attention. His well-tailored suit highlights his refined, upright posture. His gentle smile radiates a dignified, approachable aura. A ASSISTANT follows beside him.

Guests turn their heads, whispering among themselves.

The PRESIDENT rushes forward to greet Joe, eagerly leading him to the stage. With careful hands, he lifts one of “the Eye of Cyrus” and presents it to Joe.

PRESIDENT
(respectful)
Mr. Joe, this was donated tonight—a treasured artifact from the Swan family. Do you recognize it?

Joe’s eyes widen slightly as he inspects the item.

JOE
(surprised)
This is… the Eye of Cyrus?!

PRESIDENT
(nods, pointing to the other necklace)
Yes! But… there are TWO identical pieces here tonight.

CLOSE-UP: Alice and Ashley simultaneously turn toward Joe.

ALICE (V.O.)
Looks like this farce is about to end.

Ashley smirks, flashing Alice a taunting glance.

ASHLEY
(low, smirking)
You think you've won?

Ashley straightens her posture, flashing a charming smile at Joe. To her surprise, Joe meets her gaze and gives a polite nod in return.

PRESIDENT
(turning to Joe)
Mr. Joe, these two pieces came from different donors. Could you help verify their authenticity?

Joe examines both necklaces closely. His gaze lingers on Alice's Eye of Cyrus, his eyes slightly widening.

JOE (V.O.)
This is Alice Swan's necklace… Has she returned?

Joe slowly lifts his head, shifting his focus from the necklace to the PRESIDENT.

JOE
(gently, hesitant)
May I ask… who donated this piece?

The PRESIDENT blinks, momentarily taken aback, then quickly scans the room before gesturing toward Alice.

PRESIDENT
(smiling)
That young lady there.

CLOSE-UP: Alice stands tall, meeting Joe's gaze head-on with unwavering confidence, her posture poised and composed.

Joe hesitates, his voice carrying a note of uncertainty.

JOE
(softly, surprised)
You…

EPISODE 11

13 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 13

Joe rotates the ring on his finger, his mind working rapidly. Suddenly, he stops, fixes his gaze on Alice, and studies her intently.

JOE
Where did you get your Eye of Cyrus?

Alice looks back at him, surprised.

ALICE (V.O.)
He doesn't recognize me? Makes sense. I've always communicated through my personal assistant with the Swan Group CEO and he's only the Vice President.

Alice lifts her chin, offering a confident smile.

ALICE
This is a gift my dad gave me a long time ago.

Ashley steps forward, crossing her arms, a smirk tugging at her lips.

ASHLEY
(mocking)
Your father? Just now you were acting like Joe knew you, and now it's a gift from your father? Let me guess—by 'father,' you mean your sugar daddy?

A few people in the crowd CHUCKLE.

Joe's expression remains unreadable. He strides toward Ashley, bowing slightly.

CLOSE-UP: Joe elegantly lifts Ashley's hand and places a light kiss on the back of it, his thumb brushing over her palm.

JOE
(smoothly, warm tone)
Miss Ashley, how lovely to see you again.

Ashley's eyes gleam with delight, her voice turning coy.

ASHLEY
(flirtatiously)
Joe, you're as charming as ever.

GASPS ripple through the audience—

GUEST 1
Ashley and Joe know each other?

GUEST 2
(grinning, fawning)
Wow, Ashley is incredible. Even the Swan Group's Vice President treats her with respect. Why is that gold-digger still standing here?

Alice watches their interaction, her expression unreadable.

ALICE (V.O.)
Ashley and Joe look… very close. Something is definitely wrong here. I need to keep my identity hidden and uncover the truth.

EPISODE 12

14 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 14

Joe lets go of Ashley's hand. Ashley turns to Alice, smug.

ASHLEY
(adamant)
Just admit it—you're nothing but a desperate gold-digger. Your necklace is fake. Now get out.

ALICE
(firm)
Let's not jump to conclusions. Why don't we let Joe authenticate it first?

Joe looks at both necklaces, studying them carefully before putting on an air of authority.

JOE
(slowly)
The Swan family does own this treasure. However, I can't currently confirm its authenticity. But it is said that the real Eye of Cyrus glows in the dark.

Joe's lips curl into a smirk, his tone laced with condescension.

JOE (cont'd)
(pretending to be thoughtful)
Why don't we use this approach to test it later? Then we'll know which is real.
(MORE)

JOE (CONT'D)
Of course… maybe someone’s "sugar daddy" was tricked into buying a fake.

Nicole, standing nearby, immediately laughs in delight.

NICOLE
(mocking)
Can you believe Joe just called Alice’s necklace fake?!

Ashley’s two followers jeer from the sidelines. One of them picks up a piece of fruit from a nearby table and hurls it toward Alice.

FOLLOWER 1
(shouting)
Get lost, fraud!

Alice catches the hateful stares but remains composed. She turns to the PRESIDENT and the guests.

ALICE
(calmly)
We don’t need to wait. We can find a dark room and test the necklaces right now.

PRESIDENT
(nods approvingly)
That can be arranged. I’ll have it prepared immediately.

President leaves. Ashley rolls her eyes and scoffs.

ASHLEY
(smirking)
Oh, just give up. Even Joe says it’s fake.

ALICE
(raising an eyebrow)
If you're so sure my necklace is fake, then why are you afraid to have it tested?

Ashley’s confident smirk falters, her face twisting slightly.

ASHLEY
(snarling)
I’m just not interested in wasting time on losers like you. No one knows the Swan family’s treasures better than Joe and me.

ALICE
(casually)
How about a bet, then? If Joe confirms my Eye of Cyrus is real…?

Ashley clenches her jaw.

ASHLEY
(spiteful)
If your necklace is real… I'll run around the school track in nothing but my underwear!

EPISODE 13

15 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 15

Alice claps her hands, smiling challengingly at Ashley.

ALICE
(grinning)
Wonderful. Thank you for your generous support of tonight's alumni charity gala. Looking forward to your campus lingerie show.

Ashley scoffs, grabbing a glass of wine from the table and HURLING it at Alice.

ASHLEY
(hissing)
Don't be so smug—I just had your little VIP lounge humiliation video uploaded online. I bet you'll be an internet sensation soon. If you still have any sense of shame, then get out of here right now!

Alice wipes the wine from her dress. She calmly picks up another glass—and SPLASHES it right back at Ashley.

Ashley gasps, furious.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(screaming)
You—!

Alice, unfazed, tosses a second glass of wine onto Ashley before she can react.

ALICE
(smirking)
Feeling more clear-headed now? Need me to remind you that what you did is illegal? You might just spend some time behind bars.

Ashley's face burns with rage, her chest rising and falling rapidly.

ASHLEY
(snapping)
You? You think YOU can put me in jail?! I'm Gray's beloved fiancée—the future wife of the Swan family's heir!

ALICE
(smirking, coldly)
Look at you - nothing but a vicious woman. If Gray saw the real you, he wouldn't love you.

ASHLEY
(scoffs, crossing her arms)
Gray loves me now matter what. He won't fall for your nonsense.

ALICE
(leaning in, voice low)
We'll see. I'll make sure you lose everything.

DOORS OPEN. The PRESIDENT walks in, flanked by two security guards.

PRESIDENT
(sternly)
The room is ready. Mr. Joe, Miss Ashley, and Miss Alice—please bring your Eye of Cyrus necklaces for verification.

16 INT. DARK ROOM - EVENING 16

Alice and Ashley steps into the room, with the necklaces in their hand. Alice glances at the people gathered around her.

ALICE
(firmly)
Are we all set?
(MORE)

ALICE (CONT'D)
Once the lights are off, you'll witness the true glow of the Eye of Cyrus.

CLOSE-UP: The PRESIDENT gestures toward a SECURITY GUARD, who stands near the light switch, awaiting instructions.

PRESIDENT
(voice steady)
Three… two… one… Lights off.

EPISODE 14

17 INT. DARK ROOM - DAY 17

The moment the PRESIDENT gives the signal, the GUARD switches off the lights. The room is instantly plunged into darkness.

Suddenly, the Eye of Cyrus in Alice's hand emits a dazzling, radiant glow.

CLOSE-UP: The light reflects across the astonished faces of the guests, forcing them to squint and shield their eyes.

But the necklace in Ashley's hand vanishes into the darkness. Ashley's face instantly drains of color.

PRESIDENT
(shouting)
Turn the lights back on!

The GUARD flips the switch, and the room is once again illuminated. Everyone's faces flashes with surprise.

The PRESIDENT, his face filled with both shock and excitement, carefully takes the glowing Eye of Cyrus from Alice and raises it high.

PRESIDENT (cont'd)
(thrilled)
Unbelievable! The true Eye of Cyrus! Such a breathtaking jewel—it's simply one of God's most perfect creations!

CLOSE-UP: Joe stares at Alice, his expression filled with disbelief and curiosity.

JOE (V.O.)
Impossible… Could she really be… Alice Swan?

Joe discreetly leans toward his ASSISTANT, whispering.

JOE
(quietly)
Go and find out where Alice Swan is right now. Immediately.

The ASSISTANT nods and quickly leaves.

Alice turns her attention to Ashley and Joe, confidence radiating from her stance.

ALICE
(casually)
So? What do you say now, Miss Ashley? Mr. Joe?

Joe forces a polite smile, but his gaze sharpens with wariness.

JOE
(skeptical)
I must have been mistaken… However, to my knowledge, the Swan Group hasn't recently loaned out the Eye of Cyrus. Miss, where exactly did you get it?

Nicole gasps dramatically.

NICOLE
(gasping, to Alice)
Don't tell me… you stole it?!

FOLLOWER 1
(smirking)
That makes sense. She already tried to steal Gray!

CLOSE-UP: Ashley's lips curl into a triumphant smirk.

ASHLEY
(mocking)
Joe already said it—Swan Group never loaned out the Eye of Cyrus. So how did you get it, Alice? Let me guess—you brought a fake ahead of time!

Ashley suddenly turns to the crowd, addressing them loudly.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(announcing)
And swapped it with my real Eye of Cyrus! This woman is a thief! She swapped my necklace!

Whispers ripple through the guests, doubt creeping into their expressions.

GUEST 1
(murmuring)
Could that really be the truth? Well, shit happens!

Alice remains composed, then—SLAP! Alice lands a hard smack across Ashley's cheek.

ALICE
(furious)
Stop slandering me! No one swapped your necklace - because your necklace was always fake!

Alice turns to the guests, her gaze fierce.

ALICE (cont'd)
(commanding)
I hold a special position in Swan Group. You shouldn't blindly believe others and call me a thief.

Her powerful presence silences the crowd instantly. Ashley, clutching her stinging cheek, seethes with rage.

ASHLEY
(screaming)
You're insane! How dare you hit me?!

Ashley lunges forward to retaliate, but Alice swiftly catches her wrist, twisting it slightly to halt her movement.

ALICE
(coolly)
Now that I've proven my Eye of Cyrus is real, it's time for you to keep your end of the bet. You promised to run around the track in nothing but your underwear?

18 INT. WELL-LIT ROOM - DAY 18

Ashley panics, turning to Joe for help.

ASHLEY
(pleading)
Help me…

Joe frowns, his gaze shifting toward Alice, who stands with her arms crossed, smirking.

After a brief hesitation, Joe suddenly changes demeanor, flashing a charming smile as he places a reassuring hand on Ashley's shoulder. Then, he calmly walks toward Alice.

JOE
(smoothly)
Miss Alice, Ashley is just a spoiled young woman, so she occasionally throws a little tantrum.

Joe pauses, tapping his fingers thoughtfully against a nearby table.

JOE (cont'd)
But she is Gray's fiancée... Running around in lingerie would undoubtedly damage the image and reputation of Swan Group.

Alice raises an eyebrow.

ALICE
Oh?

JOE
So... I hope this bet is voided.

Alice scans between Joe and Ashley, her expression subtly calculating.

ALICE (V.O.)
Joe knows Ashley is wrong, yet he's blatantly making excuses for her. Something's definitely wrong—

Alice suddenly smiles.

ALICE
(sweetly)
Since Mr. Joe is so eager to protect Ashley, I'll let it go—on one condition.

Joe nods.

JOE
Of course. What is it?

ALICE
She must apologize to me.

Ashley's eyes widen in shock.

ASHLEY
Joe?! You want me to apologize to her?! No way!

Joe leans in, lowering his voice.

JOE
(hissing)
Until we figure out this woman's connection to the Swan Group, don't provoke her any further.

Joe drags Ashley out of the room as she grits her teeth. Before leaving, she turns around and shots Alice a vicious glare.

ASHLEY
(whispering, venomous)
You'll pay for this, bitch.

Alice watches their retreating figures, then steps out into the VIP lounge hallway.

19 INT. VIP LOUNGE HALLWAY - DAY 19

Ashley and Joe walk away, their body language suspiciously close. Alice narrows her eyes.

ALICE (V.O.)
Joe and Ashley seem way too close. There's definitely something shady going on… I need to dig deeper.

Suddenly, a hand taps Alice's shoulder from behind.

Alice turns sharply.

ALICE
(startled)
You? What are you doing here?

20 INT. VIP LOUNGE HALLWAY - DAY 20

Alice turns—it's Gray.

Startled, she swiftly steps to the side, blocking his view, then pulls him into a quiet corner.

ALICE
(surprised, firm)
Gray, what are you doing here?

GRAY
(grinning, excited)
I came straight here to hear your thoughts on Ashley! She was just on stage for the donation. Did you see her? Wasn’t she dazzling up there?

Alice takes a deep breath, locking eyes with him.

ALICE
(slowly)
Ashley? She’s not the nice girl you think she is.

GRAY
(frowning)
What? Did something happen between you two?

ALICE
(hesitant)
It’s complicated. It’s not something I can explain in just a few words. But… I think you should seriously reconsider your relationship with her.

Before Alice can continue, Gray grabs her hands anxiously.

GRAY
(urgent)
Was it because she didn’t seem smart enough and let you down? Or did she just mess up and annoy you? Ugh, I should’ve reminded her beforehand.

Alice studies Gray intently.

ALICE
(serious)
What if I told you… she did something truly terrible to me?

GRAY
(shocked, shaking his head)
How's that possible?! She’s such a kind-hearted girl—she wouldn’t hurt an ant. There’s no way she’d harm you!

ALICE (V.O.)
(sighing, resigned)
I know he won’t believe me. I’ll have to make him see it for himself.

GRAY
(exhales, calming himself)
I don’t know what’s going on, but trust me—at my proposal ceremony, you’ll see just how amazing Ashley really is!

Alice’s expression darkens slightly.

ALICE
(suspicious)
Your proposal ceremony? What are you planning?

GRAY
(grinning proudly)
I'll give up my heir status when I propose to her and promise that even if I'm not part of the Swan family anymore, I'll always have her back and take care of her.
(pause)
Come on, she’s gonna be totally moved!

Alice freezes, utterly speechless.

ALICE (V.O.)
I don’t know if Gray is a genius or a fool… but suddenly, I’m almost excited to see the proposal.

Gray steps forward, placing his hands firmly on Alice’s shoulders.

GRAY
(intensely)
As my dear sister, you must be there to witness this moment!

Alice sighs, half amused, half exasperated.

ALICE
(smiling)
Sounds great! I'll prepare a special gift for you. Get ready for a surprise.

GRAY
Thanks, sis.

Gray is so excited, he jumps up high. Alice instinctively steps back and accidentally collides with a passing WAITER, sending a tray of red wine spilling all over her dress.

EPISODE 17

21 INT. VIP LOUNGE HALLWAY - DAY 21

The WAITER panics, bowing repeatedly.

WAITER
(frantic)
Miss, I'm so sorry! I… I didn't mean to!

Gray scowls, about to lash out, but Alice quickly places a hand on his shoulder, stopping him.

ALICE
(gently)
I'm fine.

She glances down at her stained dress. Gray immediately reaches forward to help clean it.

The WAITER, still flustered, gestures toward a nearby door.

WAITER
(awkwardly)
Miss, there's a private lounge 202 down the hall. It's usually empty—if you need to change, you can use it.

Alice nods.

ALICE
Thank you.

GRAY
(concerned)
I'll go with you.

Alice quickly spins him around, pushing him back toward the main hall.

ALICE
(teasing)
No need! No need. Aren't you busy with your proposal? I happen to need something from Jason anyway, so I'll just ask him for help.

GRAY
(hesitant, glancing back)
You sure?

ALICE
(smirking)
Absolutely.

Gray finally gives in and walks away reluctantly. Alice takes out her phone and heads toward the lounge.

ALICE (cont'd)
(into phone)
Jason, bring me a new gown to VIP lounge 202. Please also help me check Joe's recent whereabouts and social interactions.

22 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202- DAY 22

Alice pushes open the door—the room is empty. Her eyes scan the bathroom door, then shift toward the couch.

Alice slips off her heels, sinking into the couch. Suddenly, she hears faint panting and moaning coming from the innermost bathroom.

Alice frowns, listening closely.

ALICE
(muttering)
What’s that?

She stands and moves toward the innermost bathroom stall door. The sounds intensify.

JOE (O.S.)
(flirty, breathless)
Oh Ashley...my baby...you smell amazing.

ASHLEY (O.S.)
(breathing heavily)
Joe… harder…

Alice’s eyes go wide. She slaps a hand over her mouth to silence her gasp.

ALICE (V.O.)
(stunned)
Ashley… and Joe?!

EPISODE 18

23 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202- DAY 23

Dim lighting casts shadows across the bathroom stalls. Alice, gripping her phone, steps forward cautiously.

OVER-THE-SHOULDER SHOT: The camera follows Alice, revealing five or six stalls in total. From the furthest stall, muffled panting can be heard.

ALICE (V.O.)
(disgusted)
These two are absolutely shameless!

Alice slips into the nearest stall, quickly activating her phone’s recording app. She presses her ear against the door.

24 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202 BATHROOM - FURTHEST STALL - SAME TIME

Joe and Ashley are tangled together.

JOE
(low groan)
Ashley, tell me—who’s better, me or Gray?

ASHLEY
(panting, breathless)
Of course, YOU!
(suddenly irritated))
But when are we finally going to act? I can’t keep pretending much longer.

JOE
(soothing her)
Be patient. Once Gray marries you, we’ll control 30% of Swan Group shares. And then… the entire company will be ours.

SUDDENLY—A PHONE RINGS. Joe stiffens.

JOE (cont'd)
(whispering)
Who’s there?!

25 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202 BATHROOM - ALICE’S STALL - SAME TIME

Inside the stall, Alice claps a hand over her mouth, eyes darting to her phone—It’s silent. But the ringing continues.

26 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202 BATHROOM - FURTHEST STALL - SAME TIME

Joe and Ashley exchange tense glances. Joe signals for silence, then slowly sets Ashley down before shoving open a stall door.

27 INT. VIP LOUNGE BATHROOM - SAME TIME 27

Joe stands, scanning the bathroom.

He turns to Ashley, signaling toward himself and a mop, then pointing at Ashley and the exit. Ashley smooths her clothes, creeps toward the door.

With a cold expression, gripping the mop like a weapon, Joe begins slamming open each stall, one by one.

28 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202 BATHROOM - ALICE’S STALL - SAME

Alice balances on the toilet seat, trying to remain unseen.

JOE (O.S.)
(taunting, approaching)
Come out. Show yourself, I know you’re here.

Alice’s heartbeat pounds in her ears.

ALICE (V.O.)
(panicked)
I need to upload the recording now.

CLOSE-UP: Her trembling fingers tap “Upload”—a progress bar slowly advances.

29 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202 BATHROOM - SAME TIME

Joe kicks open the second-to-last stall.

30 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202 BATHROOM - ALICE'S STALL - SAME TIME

CLOSE-UP: Sweat forms on Alice's forehead, a single drop sliding down her cheek.

ALICE (V.O.)
Almost there… three seconds left… hurry…

31 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202 BATHROOM - SAME TIME

Joe steps to Alice's stall.

A PHONE RINGS.

EPISODE 19

32 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202 - BATHROOM - DAY 32

Joe freezes, eyes narrowing in suspicion.

Alice clutches her phone, staring at the stall door.

JOE (O.S.)
(relaxing, sighs)
It's just someone's forgotten phone.
(shouts to Ashley)
False alarm! Let's go.

33 INT. VIP LOUNGE - BATHROOM - ALICE'S STALL - SAME TIME

Alice exhales in relief.

CLOSE-UP: The video successfully uploads.

Slowly, she climbs down from the toilet, checking through the stall door crack— The bathroom appears empty.

She cautiously pushes the door open and steps out.

34 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202 BATHROOM - SAME TIME

JOE (O.S.)
(chuckling, from behind)
I knew there was a little rat hiding here.

Alice spins around— Ashley and Joe emerge from the side door, blocking her path.

Ashley’s expression twists in disgust. She rushes up to Alice and SLAPS her across the face.

ASHLEY
(seething)
It’s you again, you filthy bitch!

Without hesitation, she slaps Alice again.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(furious)
This time, I'm going to teach you a proper lesson.

Alice catches Ashley’s wrist, gripping it tight.

ALICE
(serious, deadly calm)
Ashley, I may not be Gray’s girlfriend, but my connection with him is unbreakable. I warned you before—learn some respect!

Alice grips her phone with the other hand tightly.

ALICE (V.O.)
Jason will be here in five minutes. I just need to stall them until then.

Ashley feels a sharp pain and yanks her arm away.

ASHLEY
(scoffing)
Stop putting on an act!

Joe watches Alice closely, stepping forward.

JOE
(suspicious)
Ashley, who exactly is she to Gray?

Ashley rolls her eyes, sneering.

ASHLEY
(smirking)
Oh, her? Just another gold-digger chasing after Gray’s money. That’s all.

Joe narrows his eyes. Suddenly, he reaches out—His hand clamps around Alice’s chin, forcing her gaze upward.

JOE
(studying her, intrigued)
Strange… You do look familiar.

Alice’s heart races, but she forces herself to remain composed.

ALICE (V.O.)
(nervous)
Does he recognize me…?

EPISODE 20

35 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202 BATHROOM - DAY 35

Ashley’s jealousy flares as she watches Joe and Alice in close proximity. She suddenly shoves them apart.

ASHLEY
(furious)
Are you addicted to seducing men or what?!

Joe immediately raises a hand, blocking Ashley from lunging again.

JOE
(sharp, firm)
Enough! We have more important things to handle.

Joe’s piercing gaze locks onto Alice as he steps closer, cornering her.

JOE (cont'd)
(low, threatening)
What did you hear just now?

Alice shrugs, feigning nonchalance.

ALICE
Everything! I know a few high-level executives at Swan Group—I bet they’d love to hear the recording. What do you think, Joe?

Joe lets out a cold LAUGH before grabbing Alice’s wrist tightly.

ALICE (cont'd)
(raising an eyebrow)
Let go.
(MORE)

ALICE (CONT'D)
Or I'll make sure Gray knows about your shameless, filthy adulteress affair!

Joe's smirk deepens, his grip tightening slightly.

JOE
(mocking)
You dare to threaten me?

JOE (cont'd)
(voice dropping, dangerous)
Give me the phone.

Alice holds up her phone, casually twirling it between her fingers.

ALICE
(smirking)
Do you really think I'd store it on my phone? The video is already uploaded to the cloud.

Ashley's face contorts in rage.

ASHLEY
(snapping)
You bitch!

She lunges, trying to snatch the phone.

Alice sidesteps—Ashley crashes into the sink, sending bottles and towels flying.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(screaming)
Whore!

JOE
(commanding)
Wait.

Joe lifts a hand, stopping Ashley. He adjusts his cufflinks as he slowly walks toward Alice.

JOE (cont'd)
(coldly amused)
Young girls like you… always talking big.

He pulls out a checkbook from his pocket.

JOE (cont'd)
(smirking)
Name your price. I guarantee it'll be worth your while.

CLOSE-UP: Alice's phone screen lights up—a message from Jason:

[Miss Alice, I've arrived at the banquet hall entrance.]

Alice scans the message, then looks back at Joe, her smile turning icy.

ALICE
(firm, unwavering)
I'm not here for money. I'm going to expose your affair to everyone and make sure you two pathetic cheaters are banned from Gray for good!

EPISODE 21

36 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202 BATHROOM - DAY 36

Joe's hand clamps around Alice's throat, slamming her against the wall. His knuckles whiten from the force.

JOE
(venomous, snarling)
A pathetic girl like you thinks she can ruin me?!

ASHLEY
(mocking)
You really should've figured out who's in charge at Swan Group by now. You're nothing but a clueless piece of crap.

Alice's face reddens, her breath ragged.

ALICE
(hoarse, defiant)
Oh? I didn't realize you were running Swan Group now.

Joe's expression briefly shifts, then—

He suddenly releases her. Alice drops to the floor, coughing violently. She glares up at Joe, eyes burning with quiet fury. Joe narrows his gaze.

JOE
(quiet, dangerous)
Tell me what else you know.

Alice lifts her chin, her expression fearless.

ALICE
(smirking)
Plenty.

Alice's phone buzzes.

She reaches for it—but Joe snatches it first.

JOE
(exploding)
Stop playing games!

He slams the phone onto the floor, shattering the screen.

Ashley, growing impatient, steps forward.

ASHLEY
(irritated)
Joe, she's too slippery. Let me handle her.

Alice instinctively steps back.

ALICE
(low, warning)
If you dare hurt me again, I'll make sure you both go down together.

Jason's voice echoes from outside.

JASON (O.S.)
Miss Alice! Where are you?!

Joe's face hardens instantly. He turns his glare back to Alice.

JOE
(demanding)
Who the hell are you?!

Alice's lips curl into a smirk.

ALICE
(teasing)
Want to know?

She jerks her chin toward Ashley.

ALICE (cont'd)
(taunting)
Go ask your little mistress. I already told her when she threw paint on me.

Ashley instinctively steps back.

FLASHBACK TO:

ASHLEY
(fuming)
Who do you think you are?!

ALICE
(tilts her chin, composed)
I’m Gray’s sister. The rightful heir to Swan Group. And I do not approve of this marriage.

FLASHBACK ENDS

Ashley’s face drains of color.

ASHLEY
(stammering)
You… You’re really Alice Swan?

Alice tilts her head, amused.

ALICE
(smirking)
Took you long enough.

Joe’s eyes widen in shock.

JOE
(disbelieving)
That’s impossible. Alice Swan is abroad.

BZZT! Joe’s phone vibrates. He snatches it from his pocket, quickly unlocking it.

CLOSE-UP: A message appears—[Alice Swan has returned.]

Attached are two photos:

—Alice stepping out of a luxury car.

—Alice embracing Gray at the school entrance.

Joe’s breath hitches.

JOE (V.O.)
(stunned)
Can’t be…

EPISODE 22

37 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202 BATHROOM - DAY 37

Alice smirks at Joe, while he clenches his fists tightly.

ALICE
(smirking)
Who I am doesn’t matter anymore. What matters is that neither of you parasites are getting away with this. I’ll make sure you pay the price.

From outside, Jason’s voice echoes again.

JASON (O.S.)
Miss Alice, where are you? I brought your change of clothes.

Alice opens her mouth to respond, but—THWACK! Joe swiftly chops the back of Alice’s neck. Her eyes flutter shut as she collapses. Ashley‘s face twisting in shock and fear.

ASHLEY
(shouting)
Are you insane?! If Gray finds out, he’ll kill you!

JOE
(coldly)
And whose fault is that? You’re the idiot who pissed off the wrong person.

ASHLEY
(panicked)
What do we do now?!

Joe shoots Ashley an impatient glare.

JOE
(snapping)
Go back to the banquet hall—NOW. As long as Gray proposes, we win.

Ashley hesitates, glancing nervously at Alice.

ASHLEY
(whispering)
And her…?

JOE
(deadly calm)
Don’t ask stupid questions. Just play the role of the perfect bride-to-be. If anything goes wrong tonight, we’re both finished.

Ashley shudders, then nods frantically before stumbling out of the room from the side door.

Joe reaches to the door, dialing a number. He glances at Alice lying on the floor, then walks out the door.

38 INT. AT THE DOOR OF VIP LOUNGE 202 - DAY

JOE
(icy, commanding)
Get five security guards the watch lounge 202. Don’t let even a fly get out of the room tonight!

JOE (V.O.)
As long as I keep Alice Swan locked down, I still have a chance…

39 INT. VIP LOUNGE 202 - DAY 39

Behind the door, Alice gradually comes to her senses.

CLOSE-UP: Her lashes flutter, her fingers twitch slightly.

ALICE (V.O.)
(dazed, struggling)
Alice… wake up! You have to stop Gray before it’s too late…

Alice forces her eyes open, her gaze locking onto a catering cart in the corner.

She struggled to crawl over and squeezed herself into the catering cart. Just as Alice slips inside and hides herself under the white curtain, the door swings open—two waiters step in. They slowly pushed the catering cart forward to the door.

WAITER 1
(grumbling)
Ugh, this cart is three times heavier than usual!

WAITER 2
(laughing)
Stop complaining. The pay for this grand proposal gig is triple the normal rate!

40 INT. AT THE HALLWAY OF VIP LOUNGE 202 - DAY

The waiters push the catering cart toward the elevator. Joe frowns as the cart passes by him.

As the elevator doors start closing, Joe suddenly lunges forward.

JOE
(urgent)
Wait! I need to check the—

DING! The elevator doors shut. Joe’s face contorts in rage.

JOE (cont'd)
(snarling)
Damn it!

He KICKS a trash bin over.

EPISODE 23

41 INT. ELEVATOR - DAY 41

The elevator doors close, cutting off the sound of Joe’s furious shouting.

JOE (O.S.)
(yelling into phone)
Find that girl! Alive or dead!

Beneath the white curtain of the catering cart, Alice clutches her phone, fingers shaking as she types a message to Jason.

[Bring all the evidences you found—get to the banquet hall NOW.]

The elevator chimes. The door opens.

42 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 42

The hall is filled with elegantly dressed guests. A champagne tower gleams under the soft lighting, surrounded by an elaborate floral display.

Romantic music plays softly in the background.

On the stage, Gray steps forward, holding a bouquet of roses. Ashley stands before him, her eyes glistening, her hand delicately extended.

GRAY
(tenderly)
My dearest Ashley… On this perfect day, will you—

Just then, the catering cart shifts. Alice emerges, weak but determined. Her gaze locks onto the stage. She barely registers the pain coursing through her body. Alice's eyes land on Ashley, about to accept the ring.

In a final surge of energy—Alice grabs the tablecloth, YANKING it down.

CRASH! The champagne tower topples, sending crystal glasses shattering across the floor. Guests scream in surprise.

Alice staggers to her feet, her voice hoarse but unwavering.

ALICE
(shouting)
I DO NOT APPROVE OF THIS MARRIAGE!

CLOSE-UP: The guests whisper in shock. Gray freezes in confusion. Ashley's eyes widen in horror.

The engagement ring slips from Gray's fingers, hitting the floor and rolling away.

CLOSE-UP:

Alice—her dress ruined, hands trembling, yet her gaze blazing with defiance.

Ashley—her face twisted in terror, as if watching her world crumble apart. From the crowd, Joe steps forward, his expression dark and murderous.

Ashley's voice barely escapes in a whisper—

ASHLEY
(terrified)
We're… ruined.

EPISODE 24

43 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 43

The romantic music abruptly stops. The crowd murmurs in confusion.

GUEST 1
(annoyed)
What’s going on? Someone just knocked over the champagne tower!

GUEST 2
(peering, curious)
Who is that woman? She looks insane.

ALICE
(voice filled with fury)
Gray! You cannot marry her! She and Joe are plotting to harm you!

CLOSE-UP: Gray’s smile freezes. Seeing his sister, he immediately rushes toward her.

GRAY
(shocked)
Alice! You’re finally here!

Gray grabs Alice’s hands, scanning her from head to toe.

GRAY (cont'd)
(confused, concerned)
Sis, what happened to you?

Gray’s brows furrow deeply as Alice glares at him.

ALICE
(angry)
I almost died because of your "precious" fiancée!

Gray instinctively grabs Alice’s hand tighter, then looks toward Ashley.

GRAY
(laughing uneasily)
Ashley? Are you kidding me? She is so sweet—there’s no way she'd do something like that.

Gray pulls Ashley close, standing between them.

GRAY (cont'd)
(grinning)
Come on! I’m so glad you made it. The proposal is about to start, and I want Ashley to remember this moment forever.

Gray begins to kneel again—

Alice grabs him, stopping him mid-motion. She shoves her phone screen into Gray’s face.

ALICE
(firm, furious)
See for yourself! This is the woman you’re about to marry!

PHONE SCREEN LIGHTS UP: A video plays—

FLASHBACK TO
EPISODE 4:

—Alice’s coat is torn off, leaving her in nothing but a thin camisole.

—Nicole yanks at her clothes, smirking.

—Ashley’s voice plays over the video—

ASHLEY (V.O.)
(laughing)
Come on, let’s give everyone a show. Let’s see what you’ve got to offer.

BACK TO PRESENT.

Gray’s expression darkens as he lifts his gaze to Ashley.

GRAY
(cold, serious)
Ashley. Why were you and Nicole bullying Alice? She’s my sister!

EPISODE 25

44 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 44

Ashley’s face turns pale. She frantically waves her hands.

ASHLEY
(stammering, nervous)
This… this is all just a misunderstanding! Once the proposal is over, I'll apologize to Alice.

Alice grabs the hem of her dress and pulls it up slightly, revealing streaks of dried paint on her legs.

ALICE
(smirking, cold)
A misunderstanding? That's not what you said when you accused me of sleeping around and threw paint all over me! Don't you dare play innocent now!

Gray's eyes widen as he looks from Alice's stained legs back to Ashley.

GRAY
(shocked, demanding)
Paint? Sleep around? What is she talking about, Ashley?!

Ashley's eyes dart around, avoiding his gaze. Ashley suddenly glares at Nicole, who immediately steps forward.

NICOLE
(pulling out phone, defensive, to Gray)
It's totally because you and your sister were being too close — you hugging at the school entrance! I thought Alice was seducing you!

GRAY
(furious)
That was a French cheek kiss.

Nicole turns to Alice, raising her chin arrogantly.

NICOLE
(yelling)
Yeah, so? I took the picture! And I hit you, too! If you have a problem, come at me!

Alice LAUGHS in disbelief, rolling her eyes.

ALICE
(mocking)
It's not your turn to speak—wait until I'm done with Ashley, then I'll deal with you.

Nicole attempts to step forward, but—Joe suddenly grabs Gray's shoulder, feigning concern.

JOE
(smooth, fake sympathy)
Young people can be impulsive, and Miss Alice may have misunderstood Ashley's good intentions. But today is your big day. We should keep the focus on the proposal ceremony. Gray, what do you think?

Joe picks up the fallen engagement ring and hands it back to Gray. Then, he nudges Ashley forward. Ashley clings to Gray's arm, pouting sweetly.

ASHLEY
(coaxing, saccharine)
Gray, don't make me wait too long… My heart will be broken.

Gray hesitates—his expression torn between his love for Ashley and his loyalty to Alice.

GRAY
(after a pause)
Alice, I promise—I'll deal with this after the proposal.

Alice stares at him, appalled.

ALICE
(scoffing)
My dearest brother! You're blinded by love! Can't you just wake up and see things clearly?!

Joe's ASSISTANTS move to grab Alice, ready to force her offstage. Suddenly—

JASON BURSTS INTO THE ROOM, SHOVING PAST THE CROWD.

He holds a dress in one hand and a thick folder in the other.

JASON
(furious, shouting)
Let go of Miss Alice!

EPISODE 26

45 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 45

Jason lunges forward, shoving Joe's assistant away from Alice, positioning himself protectively in front of her.

JASON
(bowing slightly, handing Alice a dress)
Miss Alice, I'm sorry for my lateness.

Alice throws the coat over her shoulders, turning to face the room.

ALICE
(firmly)
Jason, tell everyone what you saw in the VIP room this afternoon.

FLASHBACK TO EPISODE 4:

46 INT. VIP ROOM - DAY 46

Jason bursts into the VIP room.

—Ashley and Nicole pin Alice to the floor, forcing her face against Ashley's shoe.

—Ashley raises a pen, preparing to stab Alice's face.

—The pen slams into the wooden floor just an inch from Alice's cheek.

FLASHBACK ENDS.

47 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 47

Jason glares at Ashley.

JASON
(angry)
I saw it with my own eyes—she almost disfigured Miss Alice!

Ashley's face contorts in panic as she snaps at Jason.

ASHLEY
(shrieking)
Then why didn’t you just tell everyone she’s Gray’s sister?!

The words slip out before she can stop herself. Ashley’s hand flies to her mouth.

CLOSE-UP: Gray’s eyes widen, his expression devastated.

GRAY
(voice trembling)
Even if she’s not my sister, you have no right to bully another human being.

Ashley’s lips quiver. She grabs Gray’s hand, but he shakes her off.

Gray yanks the engagement ring off his finger and throws it away.

GRAY (cont'd)
(serious, hurt)
I’m deeply disappointed in you, Ashley. I'm reconsidering our engagement.

Gray turns to Alice, extending his hand.

GRAY (cont'd)
(sincerely)
Alice, let’s go.

Before Alice can move, Ashley suddenly breaks into sobs. She rushes forward, clinging desperately to Gray’s arm.

ASHLEY
(tearfully)
Gray! I’m pregnant! Are you going to abandon our child too?!

Gray stiffens.

GRAY
(shocked)
What… did you say?

48 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 48

Ashley pulls out a pregnancy report, her hands trembling as she hands them to Gray.

CLOSE-UP: Gray's hands grasp the test—the result shows two lines.

GRAY
(emotional, overwhelmed)
Is this… real?!

Ashley sniffles, nodding shyly.

ASHLEY
(softly)
This was supposed to be a surprise for our engagement… I just never expected…
(pauses deliberately, as if holding something back)
But if I don't tell you now, I'm afraid I may never get the chance.

Ashley lowers her gaze, placing a hand over her stomach.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(sincere, pleading)
I know that ever since your parents passed away, you've always longed to have a child of own. And now… you finally do. Are you happy? This is a gift from above—meant just for us.

Gray's expression softens. He stares at Ashley, eyes filled with emotion. Ashley gently takes his hand.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(whispering, emotional)
I truly want to build a family with you, Gray—to raise our child together, side by side.

Gray hesitates for two seconds, then pulls Ashley into a tight embrace, pressing a kiss to her forehead.

GRAY
I know it must be the pregnancy hormones affecting your judgment and leading you to make mistakes.

Releasing Ashley, he turns to Alice, reaching for her hand.

GRAY (cont'd)
(overwhelmed, emotional)
I'm going to have a baby… and be a father!
(to Alice)
And You'll be an aunt!

Alice remains completely still, her eyes cold and detached.

ALICE
(firm, unwavering)
I don't want to accept this baby.

Gray's smile falters.

GRAY
(stunned)
Why? Sis, you know I've wanted to have my own child.

Alice takes a deep breath, her gaze sharp.

ALICE
Because that baby's father… isn't you.

SILENCE.

Ashley stumbles back, twisting the hem of her dress.

GRAY
(shaking his head, in disbelief)
Alice… what are you talking about? There's no way Ashley would lie to me about something like this!

Ashley's entire body stiffens. Then, without warning, she whirls toward the champagne tower, grabbing a broken shard of glass. Ashley presses the sharp edge against her throat, tears streaming down her face.

ASHLEY
(sobbing)
Gray… I never thought your family would humiliate me like this.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(voice breaking)
If I have to die for you to believe me… then fine! I'll end it now!

Ashley begins pressing the glass deeper into her skin.

Gray's eyes widen in panic—

GRAY
(frantic, rushing forward)
No!

EPISODE 28

49 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 49

Gray rushes over and tightens his grip around Ashley's waist.

GRAY
(desperate)
Ashley, don't do anything stupid!
Let's talk!

Alice doesn't even spare Ashley a glance, her expression cold and unmoved.

ALICE
(scoffing)
Don't think you can threaten me like this—I'm about to reveal the evidence of your betrayal against Gray!

Alice grabs Jason's phone, turning on the loudspeaker.

FLASHBACK—AUDIO PLAYS:

EPISODE 16—SECRET RECORDING:

JOE (O.S.)
(low groan)
Ashley, tell me—who's better, me or Gray?

ASHLEY (O.S.)
(panting, breathless)
Of course, YOU!
(suddenly irritated)
But when are we finally going to act? I can't keep pretending much longer.

JOE (O.S.)
(soothing her)
Be patient.
(MORE)

JOE (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Once Gray marries you, we'll control 30% of the Swan Group's shares. And then… the entire company will be ours.

END FLASHBACK.

DEAD SILENCE. The only sound remaining is the ragged breathing from the recording.

GUEST 1
(disgusted, gasping)
Oh my god! That's Ashley's voice! This is revolting!

GUEST 2
(whispering, gossiping)
I knew something was off between Joe and Ashley… Poor Gray, how long has he been wearing this crown of shame?

Gray staggers back, staring at Ashley in horror.

GRAY
(stunned, betrayed)
Ashley… how could you do this to me?!

Joe's expression twists into rage. He lunges toward Alice, trying to snatch the phone— Jason intercepts with a powerful side kick, sending Joe crashing to the floor. Joe snaps his head toward Gray and Ashley, his voice a furious snarl.

JOE
(shouting)
That audio is fake! Your sister is so desperate to drive me out of the company that she stooped to such dirty tricks to ruin my reputation!

Ashley bursts into fake tears, covering her face.

ASHLEY
(sobbing)
Gray… I don't know what to say… I never thought your own sister would have such hatred toward me.

Gray collapses to the floor, clutching his head in his hands, overwhelmed.

GRAY
(broken, whispering)
What on earth is going on here?!

Alice’s gaze sweeps over the room coldly before turning to Jason.

ALICE
(flatly)
Jason.

Jason reaches out, pulling out a thick stack of documents. He hands them to Alice. Alice holds them up, her voice sharp.

ALICE (cont'd)
(smirking, triumphant)
Stop acting, Joe! These documents are more than enough to send you to prison.

EPISODE 29

50 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 50

Alice flings the stack of documents toward Joe. Papers scatter across the floor.

ALICE
(smirking coldly)
Take a good look.

CLOSE-UP: The document’s title reads: Swan Group Share Transfer Agreement (Gray→ Joe).

Gray trembles as he picks up the papers.

GRAY
(shaking, voice unsteady)
This… What is this…?

Ashley suddenly screams and lunges at Alice — Joe yanks her back, his nails digging into her skin.

JOE
(low, furious)
Shut up, you idiot!

Alice doesn’t flinch. Instead, she slaps the documents against Joe’s chest.

ALICE
(voice like steel)
You used Ashley to seduce Gray...for what, 30% share of the company?

Gray stares at the papers in his hands, his body trembling in anger.

GRAY
(weak, barely whispering)
What… is happening?

Alice steps closer, voice unwavering.

ALICE
Ashley was Joe’s pawn. The second you married her, Joe would have had control over your shares. Then, he would have ousted me, making himself the president of Swan Group.

Alice locks eyes with Gray, sadness flickering in her gaze.

ALICE (cont'd)
(softly, but firm)
If you still believe them after all this, then you really are a fool, Gray.

Gray clutches the papers tighter. A deep anger and disappointment cloud his face.

GRAY
(bitter, voice breaking)
So it was all a lie... You two plotted to take over my family’s company. How ruthless can you be?

Gray’s fingers tighten on the documents, his knuckles turning white. Then, with finality, he pulls another stack of papers from his briefcase.

CLOSE-UP: The heading reads: Waiver of Succession Rights.

Gray signs his name with a shaking hand.

GRAY (cont'd)
(final, determined)
Let me pay for my blindness.

Gray hands the papers to Alice, his voice steady.

GRAY (cont'd)
(softly)
Now my sister has full inheritance rights.
(to Alice)
Swan Group will always belong to you.

EPISODE 30

51 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 51

Gray throws the documents at Ashley—the bold title reads: Waiver of Succession Rights.

GRAY
(roaring)
Get out of my sight!

Ashley's hands tremble as she picks up the papers, frantically flipping through them.

ASHLEY
(hysterical)
No… no, this isn't real! It can't be real!

Ashley grabs a bouquet from a nearby table and hurls it at Joe, the flowers smashing against his face.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(screaming)
This is all your fault! You said nothing could go wrong—but look at me now, I've lost everything!

Joe grabs Ashley by her hair, yanking it violently. The two break into a furious scuffle, Ashley's heel snaps, sending her crashing to the floor.

JOE
(adjusting his suit, coldly)
If you hadn't provoked Gray's sister, we would have won!

Ashley screeches, clawing at Joe.

ASHLEY
(hysterical)
No, it's all your fault!
(MORE)

ASHLEY (CONT'D)
If I hadn’t become your accomplice,
I’d still be Gray’s fiancée, and
soon the wife of Swan Group’s heir!

Ashley breaks away from Joe, staggering toward Gray. She clings to his legs, sobbing.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(pleading)
Gray, I beg you! I made a mistake,
but the baby is innocent!

Ashley lifts her tear-streaked face.

ASHLEY (cont'd)
(trembling)
I don’t care if you’re rich or
poor—I love you, Gray! Please…
believe me!

Gray’s face twists in disgust. He steps back, shaking off Ashley’s grip.

GRAY
(mocking)
Spare me your act, Ashley. I’m just
a penniless nobody—how could I ever
be worthy of a rich girl like you?

Ashley sees him slipping away and frantically pulls out the pregnancy report.

ASHLEY
(weakly)
Look at the test results, please!
For the sake of the baby… forgive
me!

MURMURS FROM THE CROWD.

GUEST 1
(whispering)
But… what about the child?

GUEST 2
(sighing)
A baby is innocent. Maybe Gray
should reconsider…

Gray reaches for the pregnancy test report, but Ashley tries to conceal part of it.

Gray notices her hesitation and yanks it away. His eyes scan the paper, and his expression darkens.

Gray tosses the report aside, grabbing Ashley's chin.

GRAY
(icy, venomous)
This baby… isn't mine.

EPISODE 31

52 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 52

Gray's face hardens as he slaps the pregnancy report onto Ashley's chest.

CLOSE-UP: The paper reads: Pregnancy: 12 weeks.

GRAY
(scoffing)
Twelve weeks. That's three months ago—when I was abroad with my sister. I never even touched you during that time.

Ashley stares at the report in shock, her hands shaking. Then, suddenly—she starts LAUGHING.

ASHLEY
(voice trembling)
This is absolutely impossible!

GRAY
(shouting)
Who's the father?!

Ashley whirls around, her eyes blazing with hatred. She slaps Joe across the face.

ASHLEY
(screeching)
It's him! Joe said if I got pregnant with your child, we could take over Swan Group. He raped me!

Joe's expression turns murderous. He backhands Ashley, sending her sprawling on the ground.

JOE
(snarling)
Who the hell do you think you are?! If it weren't for me, you'd still be waiting tables or washing dishes in the restaurant!

Ashley clutches her cheek, eyes blazing with fury.

ASHLEY
(pointing at Joe, screeching)
It’s all Joe’s plan! He forced me to seduce Gray!

Alice steps forward, her voice sharp.

ALICE
(firm to Joe)
Enough. The police are on their way. I’m going to press charges against you for embezzling company assets—get ready to spend the rest of your life behind bars!

Joe glares at Alice, his fists clenching.

JOE
(venomous)
I built Swan Group from the ground up! And now, how can you just take it all from me?!

GRAY
(spitting at him)
Without my sister, Swan Group would’ve been bankrupt years ago. You’re nothing but a leech.

Joe snaps, his composure shattering.

JOE
(raging)
Why should I go down alone?!

Joe jerks a finger at Ashley.

JOE (cont'd)
(spitting)
She’s just as guilty as me! If I go down, she’s coming with me!

POLICE SIRENS BLARE in the distance.

Ashley panics. She lunges at Joe, clawing at his face.

ASHLEY
(screaming)
You bastard! You’re not dragging me down with you!

Alice claps her hands. Security guards emerge from the shadows, grabbing both Joe and Ashley.

ALICE
(calm, final)
Don’t worry. You’ll both burn in hell.

EPISODE 32

53 INT. BANQUET HALL - DAY 53

Joe and Ashley are dragged away as Alice and Gray exchange glances. Alice steps forward, wrapping Gray in a comforting embrace.

ALICE
(softly)
Don’t be sad. You still have me—
I’ll always be by your side.

DISSOLVE TO:

A CLOCK—its hands spinning rapidly, marking the passage of time.

54 INT. BANQUET HALL - NIGHT 54

A glass display case holds the Eye of Cyrus, shimmering under the lights.

The president stands on stage, his voice booming with emotion.

DEAN
(grateful, passionate)
Thanks to Miss Alice Swan for her generous donation! This priceless relic will forever illuminate the path of knowledge for our students!

APPLAUSE ERUPTS. Alice and Gray stand side by side on the stage.

Gray suddenly pulls out a football, offering it to Alice.

GRAY
(grinning)
Alice, you gave me this football in middle school. Keep it for me. One day, when I make it to the pros, you’ll bring this cheering me on!

Alice catches the ball, smiling.

GRAY (cont'd)
(sighing)
I really don't dare to fall in love again... Romance is just a death trap.

Alice ruffles his hair.

ALICE
(teasing)
You'll find a girl who truly loves you—just make sure you get a little smarter this time.

TEXT ON SCREEN: ONE MONTH LATER—Gray's New College Campus

55 EXT. FOOTBALL FIELD - DAY 55

Alice and Gray sit in the bleachers, reading the news on their phones.

ON-SCREEN TITLE:

"The Vice President of Swan Corporation and His Mistress Sentenced to 20 Years for Financial Crimes"

Alice smiles.

ALICE
(satisfied)
This is what they deserve.

A referee's whistle blows.

Alice nudges Gray's shoulder.

ALICE (cont'd)
(grinning)
Alright, Quarterback—it's your time to shine!

THE END